VOLUME-2

EPISODE-5

THE COSMIC KEY

Still the same place, Bossmode.

And you are still terrible at arriving on time.

I would have arrived earlier. Unfortunately, an entire universe was having a rather difficult afternoon.

Of course it was.

It has been a long time, mate.

Far too long.

Welcome Megasto.

Come on. Tell me something. How has your little journey been?

Which part?

Start with the universe that tried to kill you.

That was not an attempt to kill me. Their sun was collapsing, and their entire civilisation had mistaken the warning signs for a religious event.

And you corrected them?

I corrected their understanding. They corrected their evacuation plan.

In another universe, I spent three years trying to convince a civilisation that their greatest hero was not supposed to prevent their extinction.

[illegible]

Three years? You could have told them in three minutes.

I did. But they see him as a God.

You haven't changed.

Neither have you. You still mistake patience for a lack of intelligence.

And you still mistake insulting your friends for conversation.

Now, Bossmode... I am thinking of going to intern-dimensions for my next patrol.

So for that I need that thing to travel.

...

What? Did I said something wrong?

What are you asking?

The thing I gave you. The Key.

The Key?

Yes. The Key.

I was going to tell you.
It was a complicated situation.
Huh?
The Key is no longer in our possession.
Master—
...
Tell me what happened.
It was supposed to be a simple operation. The Key was sent with two of my men—
They were supposed to use it as part of a plan against Alpha. I didn't know they would lose it.
Klin Ruskov and Skipper?
Yes.
They tried to retrieve it. The operation failed, and the Key ended up beyond our reach.
HIGH-SECURITY STORAGE
AUTHORIZED PERSONNEL ONLY
And you allowed it to remain missing?
I intended to recover it.
Intention is not recovery, mate.
You understand what you've lost, don't you?
...
Then perhaps it's time I explained what that Key actually does.
This galaxy contains more than worlds, Bossmode.
Every world has its own history. Every civilisation has its own sequence of events. Every decision leads somewhere.
Time is not simply a road that moves from yesterday to tomorrow. It is a structure.
Events connect to other events. Civilisations rise because certain things happen. Worlds survive because certain things do not.
The future is built upon the past. And the past is not as isolated from the future as most beings believe.
You're describing causality across multiple timelines.
That is one way to describe it.
But if every decision creates another branch—
Not every possibility becomes a separate, stable timeline.
Some branches can coexist. Some cannot. Certain events must remain in tlne order they were meant to occur.
I call it as CANON EVENTS.

When an event is forced outside its destined sequence, its consequences do not always remain where they began.

One alteration can disturb another timeline. That disturbance can reach another world, another history, another reality.

And if those disturbances continue spreading, entire timelines can collapse.

When enough of them collapse together, the damage can reach the entire galaxy.

The Key exists to prevent that.

It is not a weapon. It was never meant to be used to defeat an enemy.

It grants access to the temporal junctions where those pathways meet.

Through it, I can reach the points where the stability of multiple timelines is connected.

If an alteration threatens to spread beyond its proper boundaries, the Key allows me to stabilise the affected junction.

It gives me a means to contain the damage before it reaches other histories.

So it can reverse any change to the timeline?

No.

The Key does not grant permission to rewrite existence whenever I dislike an outcome.

It is a means of preserving the balance — not a licence to control every event.

My responsibility is to prevent one timeline from destroying another.

The Key helps me keep the timelines connected without allowing their disturbances to consume one another.

That is why it must remain beyond the reach of those who would use it for their own purposes.

One object can determine whether the entire galaxy survives?

One object can determine whether I have the means to protect it.

The galaxy does not depend upon the Key to exist.

But without it, I lose one of the most important means of keeping it safe.

...

Then why not create another Key?

Because you cannot manufacture the authority to govern time simply by reproducing the shape of an object.

Its function is tied to the temporal structure it was designed to serve. A replica would not automatically possess the same access or ability.

And if someone uses it without understanding its function?

Then they could disturb something they cannot repair.

So the people who lost it—

May not have understood what they were carrying.

I will retrieve it. Whatever it takes. I will bring the Key back.

HMMMMM...

The Key's loss...

The breach at the headquarters...

Neither event belongs to the sequence that should have unfolded.

The loss has already begun changing what comes next.

If I force the Key back into place now...

...I may create another alteration while trying to correct the first.

No more.

Got anything?

I will retrieve the Key myself.

Megasto it's my mistake.

No.

The Key's loss has already happened.

It is now part of the sequence of events that led us here.

The operation that led to its loss, the breach at the Guardians' headquarters, and the consequences that followed...

All of them now belong to that same sequence.

They were not meant to happen as they did.

They have already changed the possibilities ahead of us.

If I send your soldiers to retrieve the Key, they may cause further changes.

If I interfere too aggressively, I may create another disturbance myself.

I will not make the situation worse by trying to force the timeline back into place.

I will retrieve the Key myself, without altering the timeline any further.

I understand.

Was that changed the future that bad?

No but if key is not retrieved soon it will.

Dont do anything stupid till I come, mate.

Mhmm.

If Megasto can see possibilities stretching from the past into the future, why doesn't he use that ability to help us?

He could tell us what is going to happen. He could warn us about our enemies. He could help us win this war.

You still dont understand did you?

He shared about this long ago with me.

The timeline should progress as it is.

If he says what is going to happend tomorrow then I will try to change that tomorrow.

Yo if I change that tomorrow then there will be no today.

That will creat multiple correlated timelines which one day will collapse together and finally destroy completely.

But masted if we have a person who can see everything but doesn't helpful for us isn't it concerning?

Megasto never interrupt or prevent me from build this city because he knows this is also a part of that which he called **TIMELINE FATE.**

We are here to win this war, working for a superior mutant world but he..

He working to save this entire galaxy his duty is more important than helping us.

I understood master, Foulplay called me for a work I will leave then.

Muktinath Temple, Himalayas, Nepal.

After all these years...

I never thought I would come back here.

Nothing has changed.

Or perhaps I am the one who has changed.

DOOOONG...

DOOOONG...

How long do I have to sit here?

I remember this place.

यदि तिमी ध्यान गर्न सक्दैन्नौ भने, आफ्ने शरीरलाई नियन्त्रण गर्न सिक!
(If you cannot control your mind, learn to control your body!)

यो सजाय हो कि प्रशिक्षण?!
(Is this punishment or training?!)

I hated that exercise.

I hated him for making me do it, too.

स्थिर रह!
(Stay still!)

म कोशिश गर्दैछु!
(I'm trying!)

त्यो असम्भव छ!
(That's impossible!)

त्यसैले त अभ्यास गर्नुपर्छ!
(That's why you must practise.)

THUMP!

I thought he was the cruelest man alive.

He probably thought I was the most troublesome student he'd ever had.

गुरुजी! पानी त बरफ जस्तै चिसो छ!
(Guru-ji! The water is as cold as ice!)

शरीरले गुनासो गर्छ! मनले सिक्छ!
(The body complains. The mind learns.)

You never made anything easy for me.

But you never let me give up, either.

Katherine?

Huh?

साँच्चै तपाई नै हुनुहुन्छ?!
(It's really you?!)

यति थेरें वर्षपछि फकिनुभयो!
(You've returned after so many years!)

I'm sorry. Have we met before?

मैले तपाईलाई चिनें, तर तपाईले मलाई चिन्नुभएन!
(I recognised you, but you didn't recognise me.)

म त्यतिबेला सानो थिएँ।
(I was very young back then.)

आउनुहोस्। गुरुजीले तपाईलाई देखेर खुसी हुनुहुनेछ।
(Please, come. Guru-ji will be happy to see you.)

Guru-ji is still here?

उहाँ अझै यहीं हुनुहुन्छ।
(He is still here.)

यसतर्फ आउनुहोस्।
(This way, please.)

फेरी प्रयास गर!
(Try again!)

CLATTER!

QUEEN SORCERER
रानी जादूगरनी

What ?
Is that Me?

तपाईको मूर्ति।
(Your statue.)

My statue?

तपाई यहाँबाट गएएछि धेरै कुरा परिवर्तन भए।
(Many things changed after you left.)

वियार्थीहरुले तपाईलाई आदर्श मान्न थाले।
(The students began to look up to you.)

I didn't know any of this.

तपाई फर्किनभुएको थिएन।
(You never returned.)

गुरुजी, उहाँ आउनभुएको छ।
(Guru-ji, see who it is.)

भित्र आउन देऊ।
(Let her come in.)

...Guru-ji.

मलाई माफ गर्नुहोस्, गुरुजी।
(Please forgive me, Guru-ji.)

काठे...
(Kaathe...)

धेरै ढिलो गरिस, छोरी।
(You've taken too long, child.)

कस्सी छेस, काठे?
(How have you been, Kaathe?)

I'm fine fine, Guru-ji.

सताइस वर्ष वितिसके, काठे।
(Twenty-seven years have passed, Kaathe.)

तिमी यहाँबाट जाँदा आझै धेरै कुरा सिक्न बाँकी थियो।
(When you left here, there was still so much for you to learn.)

I know.

तिमी गएपछि यहाँ धेरै कुरा बदलियो।
(Many things changed after you left.)

नयाँ विद्यार्थिहरु आए। पुराना विद्यार्थिहरु गुरु बने।
(And new students came. The old students became teachers.)

अनि केही विद्यार्थीहले तिमीलाई आफ्नो प्रेरणा बनाए।
(And some students made you their inspiration.)

I never asked to become anyone's inspiration.

QUEEN SORCERER
रानी जादूगरनी

प्रेरणा बन्न कसैले अनुमति माग्नुपर्दैन, छोरी।
(One does not need permission to become an inspiration, child.)

तर तिमी यहाँ ती कथाहरु सुन्न आएका होइनौ, हैन?
(But you haven't come here to hear those stories, have you?)

No, Guru-ji.

I need to understand something about myself.

Everything I learned here... every ability I developed... every spell I mastered...

Was that everything I was capable of?

Or did I already possess abilities before I ever came to this temple?

...

Guru-ji?

आउ, काठे।
(Come with me, Kaathe.)

हामीलाई केही समय एकलै छोडिदेऊ।
(Leave us alone for a while.)

हुन्छ, गुरुजी।
(Yes, Guru-ji.)

What is it?

केही कुरा समयसँगै हराउँदैनन्।
(Some things do not disappear with time.)

That...

Where did you get that?

तिमीले यहाँ छोडेर गएकी थियौ।
(You left it here when you departed.)

I thought I'd lost it.

तिमीले यसलाई सामान्य गहना ठानेकी थियौ।
(You thought it was an ordinary ornament.)

तर यो सामान्य गहना होइन।
(But it is not an ordinary ornament.)

What does it mean?

यो चिन्ह ती परिवारहरूलाई दिईन्थ्यो, जसले आफ्नो सन्तानका लागि विशेष रासायनिक उपचार स्वीकार गरेका थिए।
(This mark was given to families who accepted a special chemical treatment for their children in your country.)

A chemical treatment? What are you telling me?

यो उपचारले मानिसको शरीर र उसको क्षमतामा परिवर्तन ल्याउन सक्थ्यो।
(This treatment could change a person's body and abilities.)

तिमीसँग यो चिन्ह थियो, काठे।
(You had this mark, Kaathe.)

No...

Are you saying I was one of them?

तिमी यहाँ आउनुभन्दा अगाडि नै तिमीमा असामान्य क्षमता थियो।
(You already possessed unusual abilities before you came here.)

तिमीलाई त्यसबारे थाहा थिएन।
(You did not know about them.)

But I thought... I thought everything began here.

Then what am I?

तिमीमा रहेको शक्ति बुझ्न आज्ञै बाँकी छ, काठे।
(There is still much for you to understand about the power within you, Kaathe.)

जब तिमी पहिलो पटक यहाँ आएकी थियौं, हामीले तिम्रो क्षमतामा केही असामान्य कुरा देख्यौं।
(When you first arrived here, we noticed something unusual about your abilities.)

तिमीले सिकेका कुराहरू अरू विद्यार्थीहरूले भन्दा धेरै छिटो आत्मसात् गर्‍यौं।
(You absorbed what you learned much faster than the other students.)

तिम्रो शक्ति अरूको जस्तो थिएन।
(Your power was not like the others'.)

तिमी पुर्‍याँली शक्तिहरू छिट्टै आत्मसात् गर्न सक्थ्यौं।
(You could adapt to ancestral powers quickly.)

पुराना साधकहरूबाट आएका शक्ति र विधिहरू बुझ्ने, सिक्ने र आफ्नो अभ्यासमा ढाल्ने क्षमता तिमीमा थियो।
(You had the ability to understand, learn and adapt powers and disciplines passed down from ancient practitioners.)

If I had that ability, why didn't I know?

क्षमता हुनु र त्यसलाई नियंत्रण गर्न जान्नु एउटै कुरा होइन।
(Possessing an ability and knowing how to control it are not the same thing.)

यहाँ आएपछि तिमीले ध्यान गर्न, आफ्नो मन स्थिर राखन र आफ्नो शक्तिलाई केन्द्रित गर्न सिक्यौं।
(After coming here, you learned to meditate, steady your mind and focus your power.)

हामीले तिमीलाई शक्ति दिएका होइनौं, काठे।
(We did not give you your power, Kaathe.)

हामीले तिमीलाई त्यसलाई चिन्न र प्रयोग गर्न सिकायौं।
(We taught you to recognise and use it.)

तिमीले सिक्ने गति हामीले कहिल्यै देखेका थिएनौं।
(We had never seen anyone learn at your speed.)

तर तिम्रो क्षमता कति गहिरो थियो भन्ने कुरा तिमी आफैंलाई पनि थाहा थिएन।
(But even you did not know how deep your abilities were.)

I left before finishing my training.

हो।
(Yes.)

I have to go.
I have to find the people responsible for Emma.

तिमी आफ्नो साथीको मृत्युको बदला लिन गयौं।
(You left to avenge your friend's death.)

तिमीले आफ्नो बाटो रोज्यौं। त्यसपछि तिमी कहिल्यै फर्किएनौं।
(You chose your own path. After that, you never returned.)

I thought I had finished everything I needed to learn.

तिमीले धेरै कुरा सिक्यौं, काठे। तर सबै कुरा होइन।
(You learned many things, Kaathe. But not everything.)

तिम्रो शक्ति अझै पूर्ण रूपमा विकसित भएको छैन।
(Your power has not yet been fully developed.)

You are the best of all here, Kaathe.

All this time...

I believed I was simply a human being who learned magic here.

But I was already different before I ever arrived.

MGen83'

MGen83'...

If that chemical changed so many lives, was I connected to it too?

I came here because I needed to understand who I am.

And now I know I have more to learn than I ever imagined.

त्यसो भए, कोत्टे... अब के गछ्युौ?
(Then, Kaathe... what will you do now?)

I need to go back.

Thank you for telling me the truth.

फेरि अधुरै छोडेर जान लागेकी?
(Are you going to leave things unfinished again?)

तिमीभित्र असाधारण क्षमता छ, कोत्टे।
(You possess extraordinary abilities, Kaathe.)

तिमीले अभ्यास गरयौ भने, तिमी प्राचीन साधकहरूमध्ये सबैभन्दा महान् बन्न सक्छ्युौ।
(If you train, you could become the greatest among the ancient sorcerers.)

तिमीले प्रयास गर्‌यौ भने अरूले देख्न नसकने कुरा देख्न सक्छ्युौ।
(If you try, you may see what others cannot see.)

अरूले गर्न नसकने कुरा गर्न सक्छ्युौ।
(You may do what others cannot.)

तर त्यसका लागि तिमीले आफ्नो प्रशिक्षण पूरा गर्नुपर्छ।
(But to do that, you must complete what you left.)

MGen83'

Right.
I need that too.

MAFFY'S ROOM
DARK CITY - MORNING

Ihan.

What?

How long are you going to keep doing that?

Until it works.

Very informative. Thank you.

This room has absolutely no organisation.

ABAL!

WHAT?!

...

Hey, Muffy.

Do you guys seriously have nothing better to do?!

I was looking at the floor!

The floor?!

It's a very interesting floor!

You've been sitting in my room for half the day!

Technically, I've been lying down.

That makes it worse!

Ihan's doing something important. I'm helping him.

Ahem.

Big help.

You could at least pretend to respect my contribution.

Your contribution is taking up space on the bed.

Emotional support is a real job dude!

You're not even supporting yourself properly.

Both of you are unbelievable.

Oh? So you **DO** know how to sit like a normal person.

I was testing the bed's structural integrity.

And?

It passed.

Hey... do you remember when we made this?

12 YEARS OLD
DARK CITY - FLASHBACK

Of course I remember.

We were twelve. Your father wouldn't let you go outside that alley, so you came to us crying.

I did NOT cry!

I didn't say you cried.

But you just did!

You cried, girl. Accept it.

You weren't even looking at me!

I didn't need to. We could hear you from the next alley.

I remember the neighbours closing their windows.

I hate both of you.

Anyway, we told you that whenever you felt worried, you should keep something with you that reminded you we were there.

So you started making this little Maffy.

I was worried, that's all.

Also crying.

I WILL THROW SOMETHING AT YOU!

I still think, it looks good.

You know, in Ashton, they probably sell these things in much better quality.

So?

So... you could get a better one?

You think I'm going to leave this place for one stupid doll?

I didn't say that!

You were thinking it!

I was thinking about the doll!

You were thinking about Ashton!

To be fair, Ashton has plenty of equipment we don't even know how to operate.

Probably entire buildings full of things you two would break within five minutes.

Exactly! Imagine the technology there. The buildings, the vehicles, the machines–

Here we go again.

And the clothes! The shops! All the things people our age get to experience there!

What things?

You know... girls' things, like your inne...

I don't care about those things, Abal! And please stop repeating the same things about Ashton every single time we talk!

...Okay.

Abal...

I know your dream is to see Ashton.

I know how much it means to you.

But you need to understand something. It's almost impossible now.

They've upgraded the border again. We can't even get close to those walls anymore.

...

Okay, then what do you want me to say?

Should we just leave? Walk out of here and abandon everyone and everything?

CLICK

Guys.

Guys, it's done.

What is that?

A broken video camera.

You spent half the day fixing that?

I spent half the day making it work. There's a difference.

I found it near the border. It was damaged, but the storage unit survived.

You found a camera near the border and didn't tell us?!

I wanted to see if I could recover anything first.

Let's see.

BZZZT...

CLICK

Wait...

ASHTON
CAPITAL DISTRICT

...Whoa.

ASHTON
CENTRAL DISTRICT

That's real?

Mf then what is that it is Ashton dude.

ASHTON
RESIDENTIAL ZONE

They really live like that?

Looks like it.

WAIT!

REC

00:02:17

ASHTON NEWS

ALPHA VOID HELPS INJURED CIVILIAN

LIVE

WORLD NEWS

ALPHA VOID ADDRESSES GLOBAL CONFLICTS
PEACE THROUGH STRENGTH"

My god it's Alpha void
Man he's so powerful

E THE CITY

Definitely.
They treat him like
a god over there.

Maybe mutants there
are actually respected.
Maybe they can live without
everyone being afraid of them.

What? Are you
going to kill him
by staring?

I've never seen
anyone this manly
before.

Ah, hello?
I'm right here!

He's so fine.
I think I finally
understand why you
like him so much.

You two are
unbelievable.

Hey!

ASHTON CITY

A STRONGER
WORLD
UNITES
BEYOND
CONFLICT

FOR A SAFER
TOMORROW

Dad
Calling...

Why am I so useless?

My whole life...

My own parents lied to me my whole life.

They knew what they were doing. They knew what they wanted me to become.

And they let me believe everything happened naturally.

REC

00:14:27

And Alpha...

I watched them hurt him.

I knew what was wrong, but I couldn't do anything.

What am I supposed to do now?

Rampage...

He hides his identity better than anyone.

He knows how to keep something secret, even from people who work beside him.

Maybe he can help me figure out what to do.

I can't keep sitting here.

OUTSKIRTS OF ASHTON

SHING!

SHING!

FSHHT!

FSHHT!

FSHHT!

What's your job here, Atom Girl?

Good morning to you too.

You haven't answered my question.

Maybe I came to see how you train.

Or maybe I needed to talk to someone.

Then talk.

My parents lied to me.

Not about one thing. Not about some little mistake.

They knew the truth from the beginning. They let me grow up believing something that wasn't true.

You never told anyone?

I didn't know how.

I still don't know what I'm supposed to do.

FSHHT!

WHAT THE—?!

WHAT THE HELL WAS THAT?!

You caught it.

YOU THREW A WEAPON AT MY FACE!

And you caught it.

That's what you've been facing, isn't it?

Things you didn't expect. Things you weren't prepared for. Situations that suddenly appear in front of you.

Your nervous system reacted before you had time to think. Your power followed that reaction, and you defended yourself.

That's what you need to learn to do.

Not stand there, spread your hands and tell yourself you can't do anything.

You can be scared. You can be angry. You can be confused.

But you should never be hopeless.

There was a time when I had something I couldn't afford to lose.

The people I worked for tried to hurt my sister. They thought they could use her to control me.

ALLEY CORP

I wiped out the entire Alley Corp because they thought about hurting my sister.

That was the last decision I made for myself that changed everything.

It was the right decision for me.

But I'm not going to tell you what your decision should be.

What you choose to do will shape your future, Atom Girl.

But what you do now? That's who you are.

I can't tell the others. Not yet.

But I can still do something.

A small hospital in Dark City.
A place for those who are forgotten.

CITY GENERAL HOSPITAL

78
96
18

Well, well.
Look who's still breathing.

If you're here to laugh, get out.

If I wanted to laugh at you, I wouldn't have wasted my time coming here.

Severe chemical destruction. No viable tissue remaining below the injury.

I don't need a scientist to tell me what happened to my own body.

Then let's skip the medical report. I'm here because I know you want revenge.

Hazard took your hand.
The Guardians defeated you.
You failed your mission.
And now you're lying in a hospita
that barely has enough medicine
to keep you alive.

Tell me, Klin...
are you satisfied with how that ended?

I will tear that chemical freak apart.

That's the answer I expected.

Good. Because I'm putting together people who have unfinished business with the Guardians.

And you think I should join you?

I think you should stop wasting time in this bed.

Revenge is considerably easier when you're properly equipped.

Custom-built. Reinforced structure, enhanced gripping force, and a response system designed to adapt to your movements.

It isn't merely a replacement for what you lost.

It can generate force far beyond an ordinary human limb. Its internal systems can also channel power through the hand.

You made this... for me?

I made it for someone who knows what to do with power.

Whether you deserve it is a different question.

Don't mistake this for charity, Klin.

We have enemise in common. And I want people beside me who can actually hurt them.

The Guardians...

HAZA

ALPHA

EXTINCT

CLACK

This is only the basic demonstration. Its full capabilities its considerably greater.

You can stay here and remember what they took from you.

Or you can make them remember you.

...

This is the laboratory Alpha and Adam Taylor talked about I guess.

ASHTON ADVANCED RESEARCH LABORATORY SECTOR-17

Walking straight in would be stupid.

Let's watch and wait.

Come on... give me something

You don't look like researchers.

A secret handover right outside the lab?

Let's see where you're taking that.

ASHTON MART

ASHTON CITY HOSPITAL

The laboratory... to a hospital?

MGen83'

Is that the chemical they talked about is inside?

I can't just grab it. I don't know who they're working for, or how many people are involved.

Only one who knows about is Alpha... what happened to you man.

What's next? What's next...

Thief! Stop him!

He stole from my shop too!

Seriously? Now?

Fine. One problem at a time.

You've got to be kidding me!

You're not losing me that easily!

KRAAAH!

...Who tf thrown him?

Whaaaaat?!

Hello, Atom Girl.

TO BE CONTINUED...